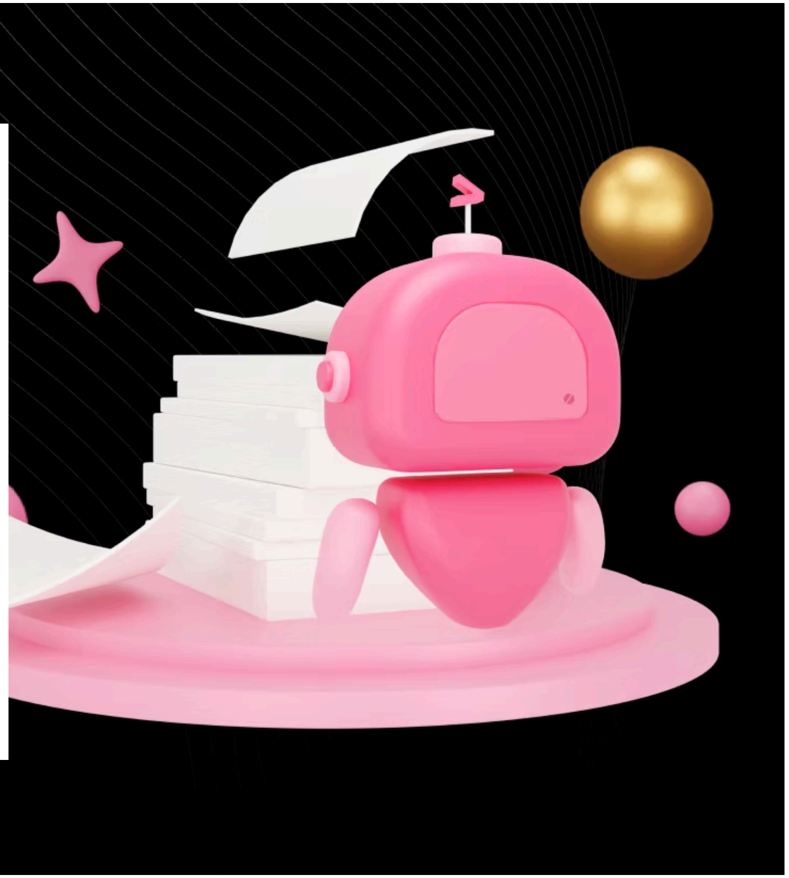
LAZYPAY

Building an in-app Chat Assistant

Conversation Design and IA for an in-app automated Help and Support bot that can provide quicker factual resolutions for users and increase customer satisfaction



📓 Project Brief

Design the entire end-to-end conversation flow, information architecture, and category tree for an in-app support chatbot

⏳ Duration / Size

2 months / XL

💁 My Role

Took ownership of formulating the information architecture. content strategy, and end-to-end conversation design, with support from the designer and PM

📝

Problem Statement

82% of queries (>50K per month on avg.) received by our call center can be resolved with factual information. Our objective is to reduce total number of incoming calls to customer care executives, as well as increase CSAT with a better support experience.

💰

Business Impact

Targeting even a **60% resolution rate** via chat would lead to a monthly savings of at least **₹700K**.

💬

Why a chatbot and not something else?

- One-time build cost: Reduced cost of labour force
- Cross-sell benefits: added incentive for users to download our app
- Instant resolutions vs Wait time on phone call / email
- Easier data gathering: to track and analyse conversations for future improvement

Constraints for Phase I

Based on our timelines, all stakeholders collectively decided on the following

01.

Capabilities limited only to Help & Support

02.

Use a simple decision tree logic, not NLP

03.

Bot has a persona, but no name or avatar

04.

Use a third-party vendor, not native

05.

Every new chat carries same context

The Process

Gather Research & Data

I first collated all the available data in the system, analysed the results, and used that as the foundation for the next step.

Create Guidelines

Decisions were made with stakeholders to create rules and frameworks for building the tree and common components in the flow.

Test Initial Prototypes

In the spirit of build fast, fail fast I made prototypes for select user queries and tested out the conversation flows.

Build Tree & Final Design

After collecting feedback from the tests, I designed the entire conversation tree, along with the app screens to ensure discovery.

1️⃣

Gather Research & Data

Collected quantitative & qualitative resources from the UX research team and customer care team, through various methods including:

- Going through user interviews, customer care recordings, and transcripts
- Monthly customer care reports to identify top issues & their distribution
- Competitor analysis of other fintech apps and the language used in their Help & Support sections
- Mapping the user journey and creating mind maps with the designer and PM

🧠

Insights

Top Issues

Account related	Loans and EMIs	Charges and fees
I want to delete my account	What's the status of my loan	What is the latest fee structure
Unable to log in	How many EMIs are left	Why was I charged interest
My account is blocked	About loan foreclosure	Need late fee wai

2

Guidelines and Framework

Our bot's tone is empathetic

Users who reach out to Help & Support are not usually in a positive state of mind. Emotions can range from slightly annoyed to angry.

Hence, the ideal tone for a helpful and reassuring chatbot is warm, friendly, and empathetic, maintaining a professional yet approachable demeanor to create a positive and supportive user experience.

Our bot should be co-operative and follow turn-taking

The information provided by the bot should be relevant, truthful, unambiguous, and just as much as is necessary. The bot must take turns in the same way a real conversation progresses.

Each node should have at most 3 options

Simplify decision-making for a user, while also presenting them with enough choices. This rule applies to every node except the first level of choices (our main menu).

The user must always be in control

Only the user gets to end the conversation, not the bot. They always have the option to exit, go back, or restart the flow at any given time.

3️⃣

Prototype and Test

Before building the entire tree, it was essential to prototype and test our basic hypotheses and insights. We tested the top 3 queries for:

Information Architecture

What is the user's mental model? Do they seek help based on Use cases or based on Products? What should our top-level categories look like?

We tested **2 prototypes**: One with Use Case categories, one with Product categories.
Both contained flows for top customer issues. A total of **10 user sessions** were conducted.

1

Users found use case categorisation more intuitive

Finalised this categorisation

2

Users like the "Top questions" section

Positive feedback

3

Some users wanted the option to type freely (NLP)

Added to Phase II scope

4

Suggested an option to raise ticket within app instead of just sharing customer care no.

Added to Phase II scope

5

Some users wanted more visual cues along with text

Added rich media like PDFs, images, videos to answers

6

Users were comfortable with the interface and format

Positive feedback

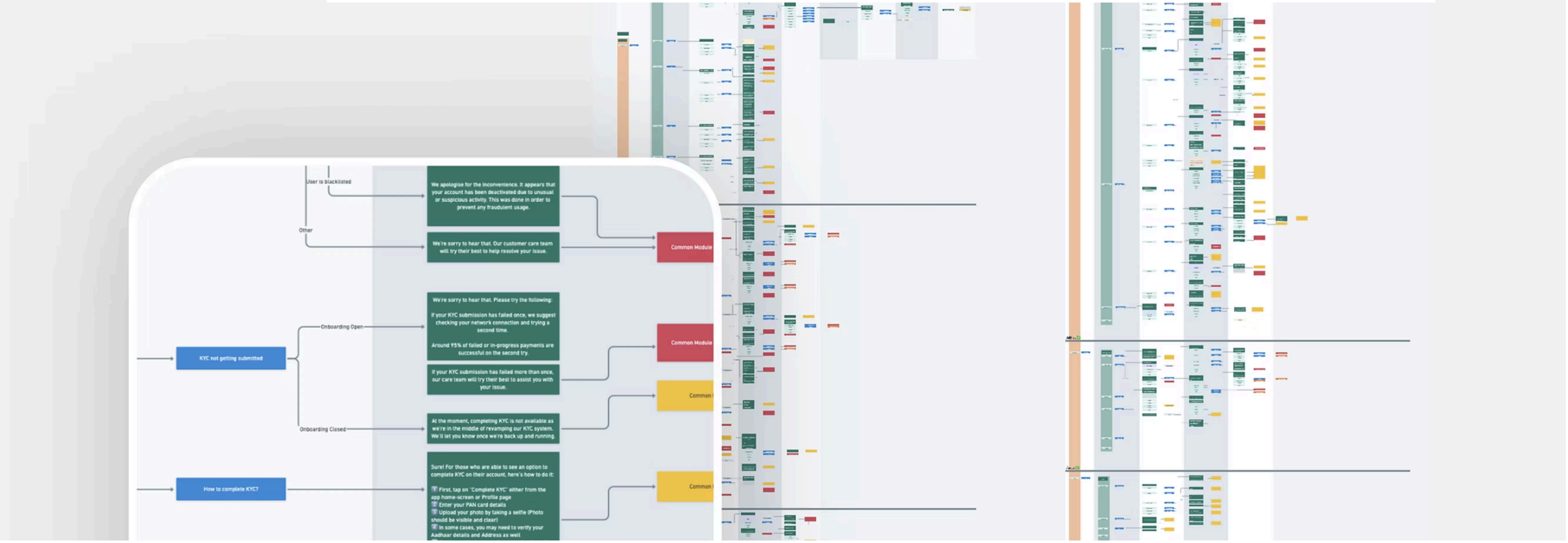
Chatbot Edited 2 years ago

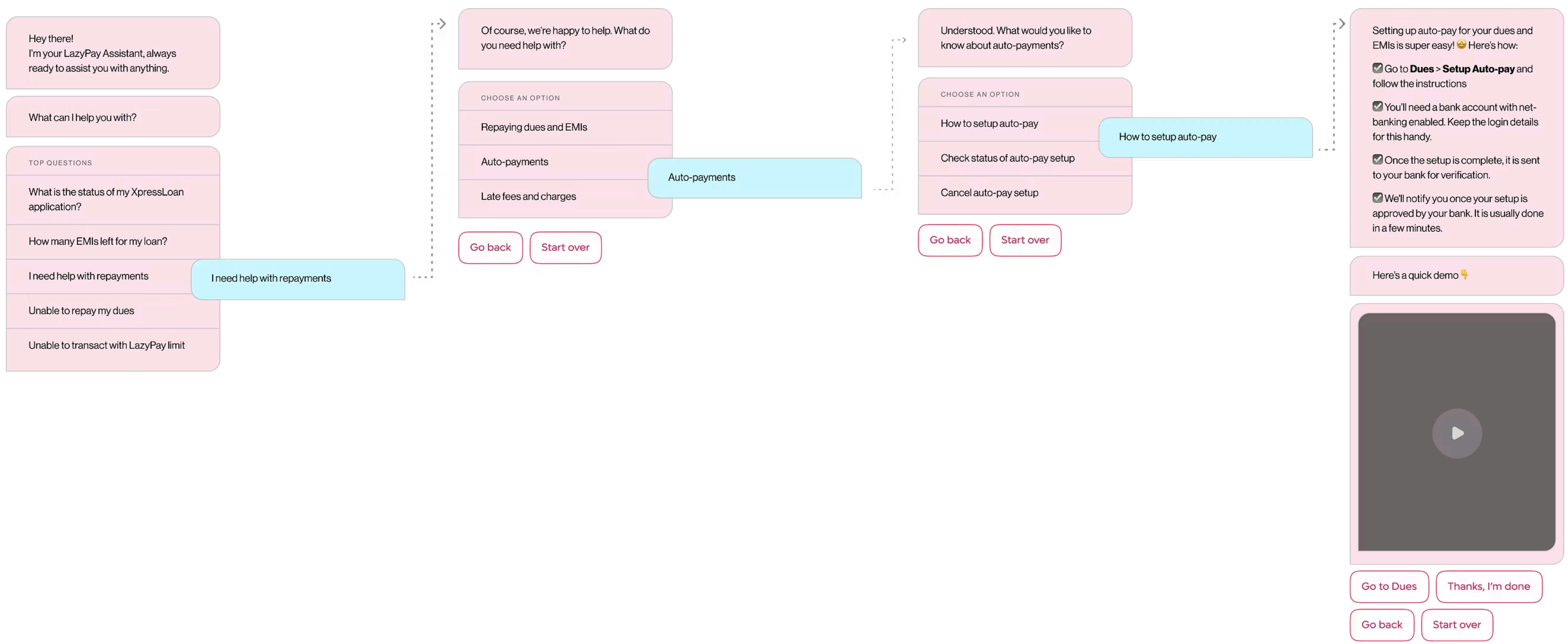
4

Final tree and designs

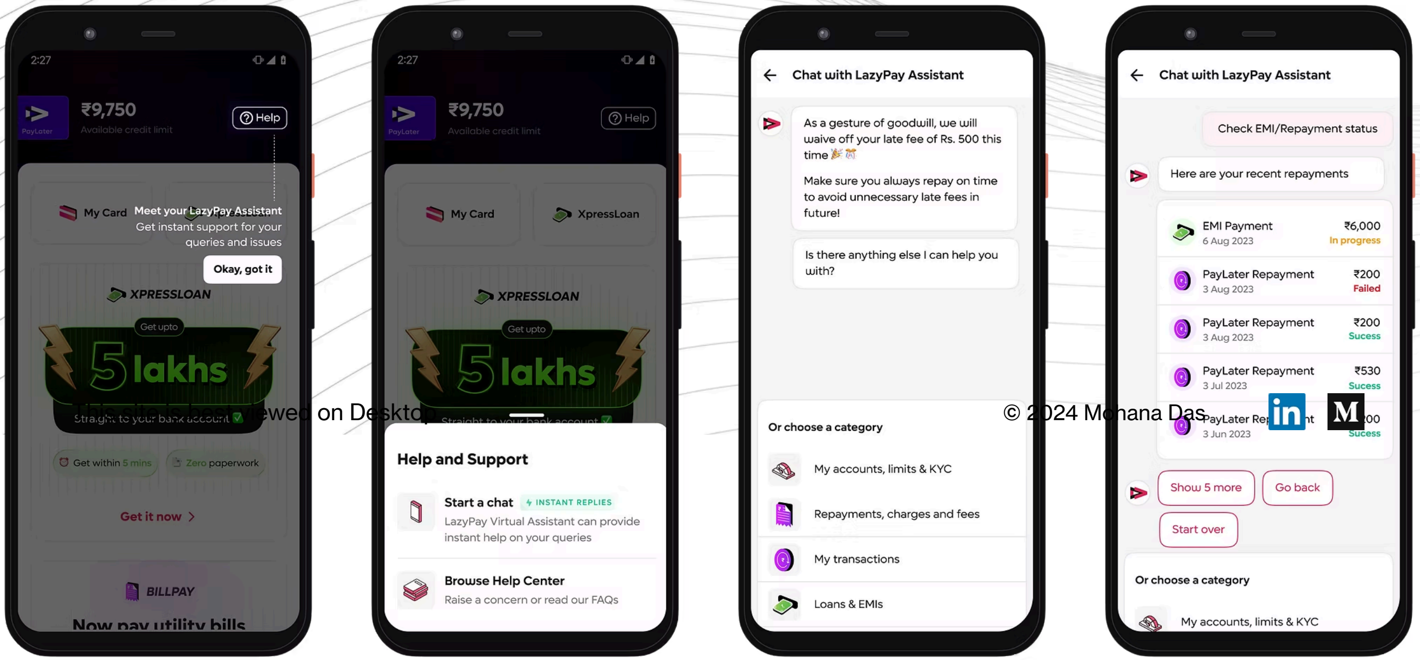
The entire decision tree spanned 5 product lines with interconnected flows, and covers everything from transactions to repayments, and more (image shown to scale).

A sample conversation is added below.





The app UI was also finalised by me and the product designer, with a focus on discoverability and comprehension.



Thanks for reading!

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